



Apprentice

FIRST DEGREE LECTURE OF THE A.O.F.G.

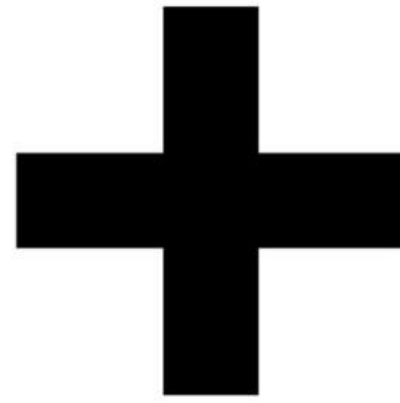
United Council

A.O.F.G.



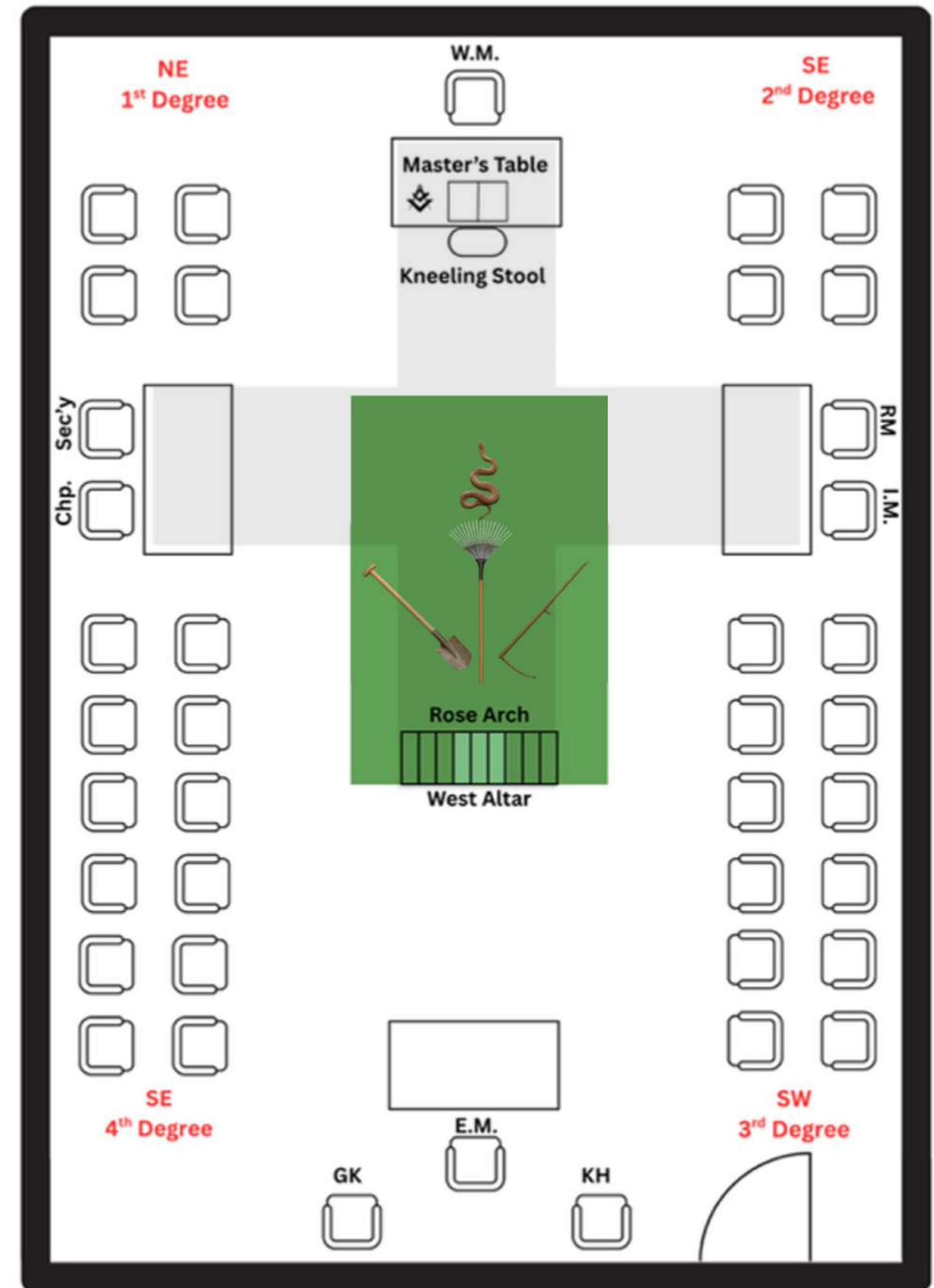


Lodge Diagram



G R E E K C R O S S

- Worthy Master (East)
- Secretary and Chaplain (North)
- Rentmaster and Instruction Master (South)
- Emissary Master (West)
- The Altar in the West (Western Altar) is under the rose arch.



The Altar & Tables

- The Altar in the West/Western Altar
- Noah's Altar (Genesis 8:20)
- The WM's table is not an altar
- All tables are equal in height



“Then Noah built an altar to the LORD and, taking some of all the clean animals and clean birds, he sacrificed burnt offerings on it.”
Genesis 8:20 (NIV)

—

Four Parables of Paradise

	1st degree	2nd degree	3rd degree	4th degree
The Four Parables	Pink Rose	White Rose	Red Rose	Olive Branch
Symbolic Meaning	Faith	Hope	Love	Fulfillment



Tools of the West

Spade - Rake - Scythe



Tools of the East

	1st Degree	2nd Degree	3rd degree	4th degree
The Four Great Lights	Compass	Square	Pruning Knife	Bible
Tools of the East	Compass	Square	Pruning Knife	
Tools of the West	Spade	Rake	Scythe	
Sacred Virtues	Faith	Hope	Love	Fulfilment





Four Great Lights of Free Gardening

Inner Paradise Garden

- Pishon
- Gihon
- Hiddekel (Tigris)
- Euphrates



Creatio Ex Nihilo

- Pre-existing Creation
- The Apprentice Degree working carpet is a reflection of the 5th day of creation (Genesis)

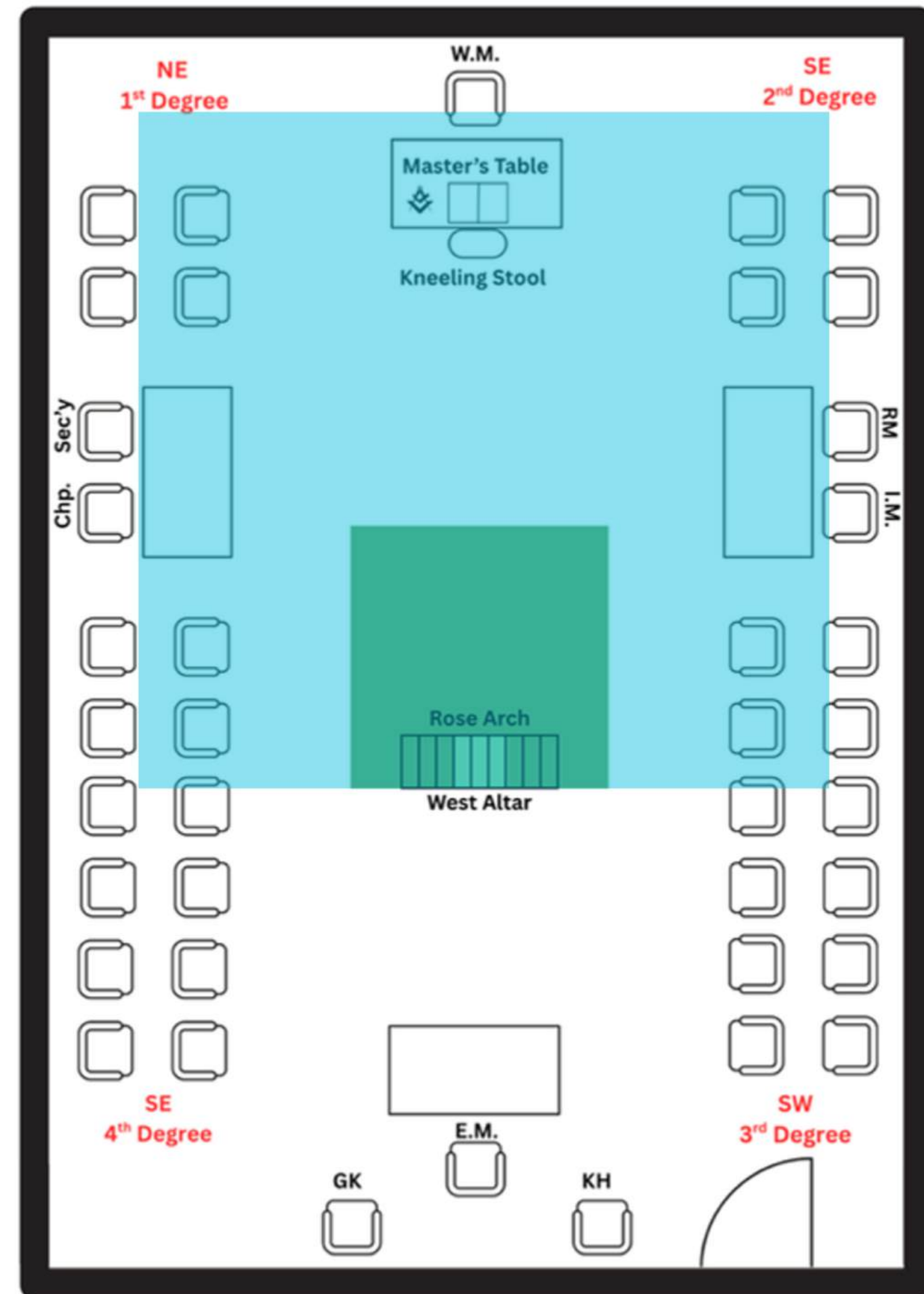


The Lodge Room

- Apprentice sit in the NE during the 1st Degree Ceremony
- NE is a place of *obscured luminescence* (between light and dark)
- The Axis between the WM and the Western Altar is never crossed (except during degree work)
- Secretary assists in distributing the Regalia in 1st and 3rd degrees
- Rentmaster assists in distributing the Regalia in the 2nd and 4th degrees

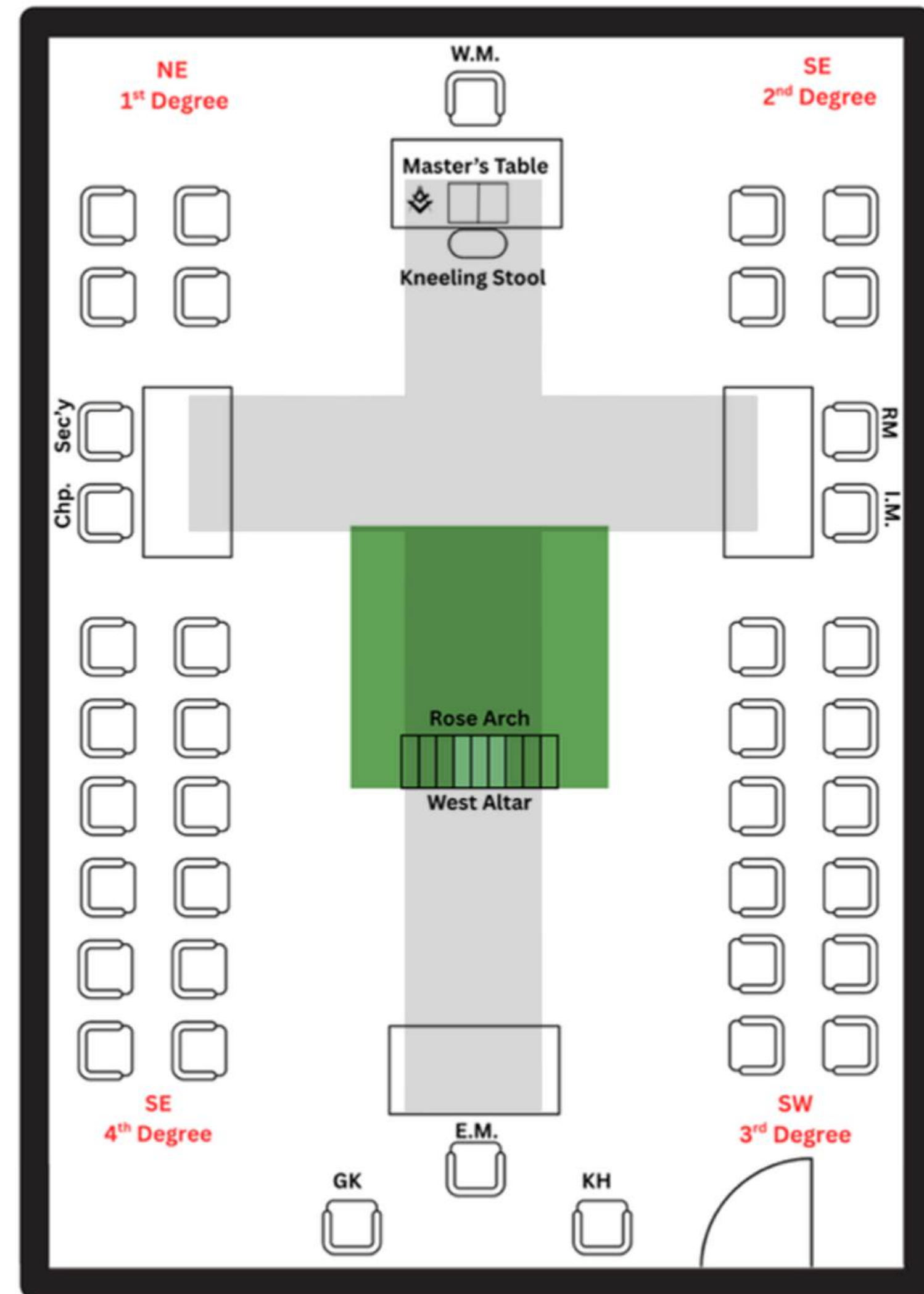
The Lodge Room

- Inner Keepers - Worthy Master, Secretary, Chaplain, Rentmaster and Instruction Master
(Paradise Garden)
- Outer Keepers - Emissary Master, Keyholder and Gatekeeper (outside of Paradise Garden)



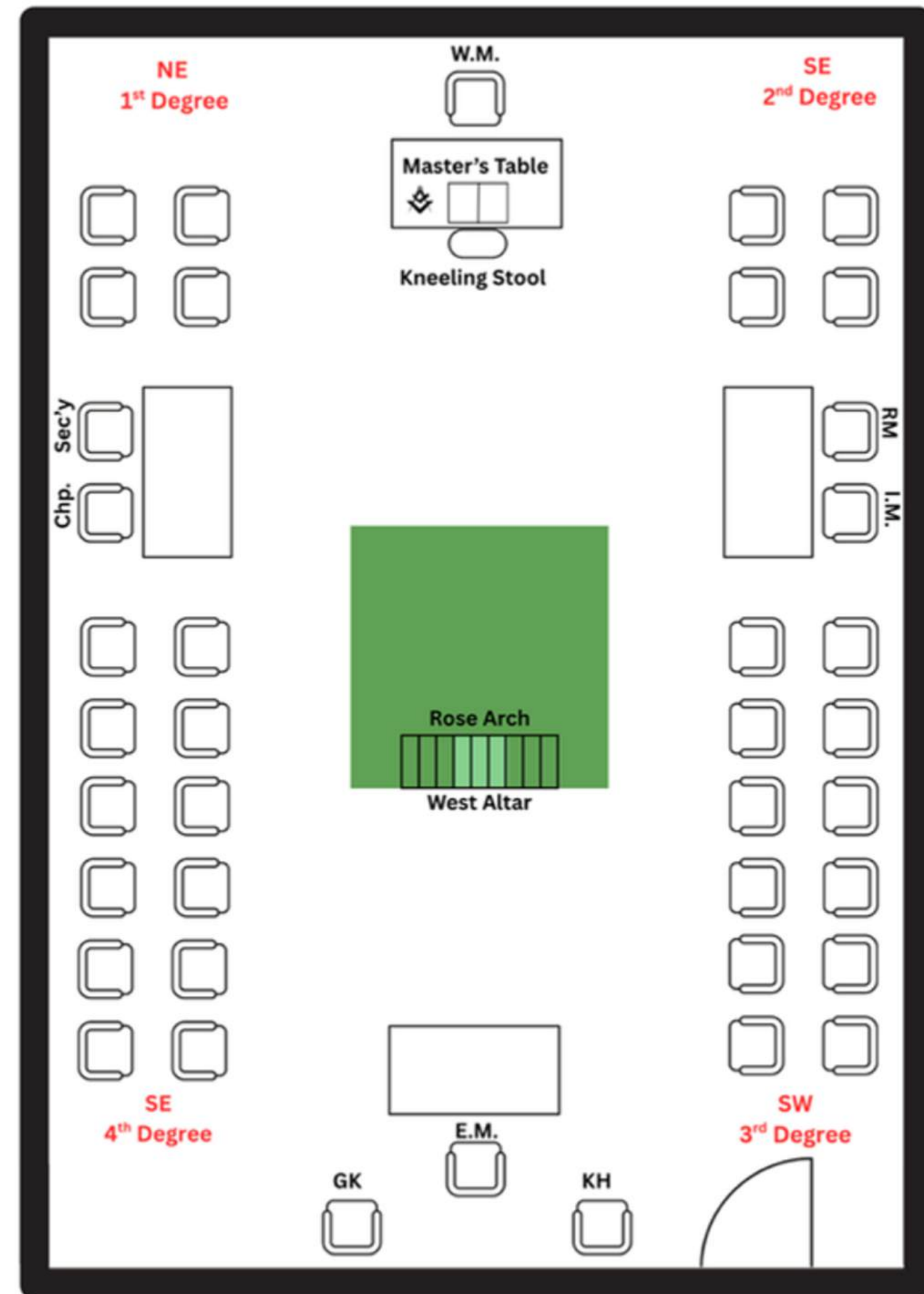
The Lodge Room

- Keepers Tables (including EM's) forms a Latin Cross
- Westward extension to the EM's Table is symbolic access to the Garden of Paradise (Eden)/state of perfection



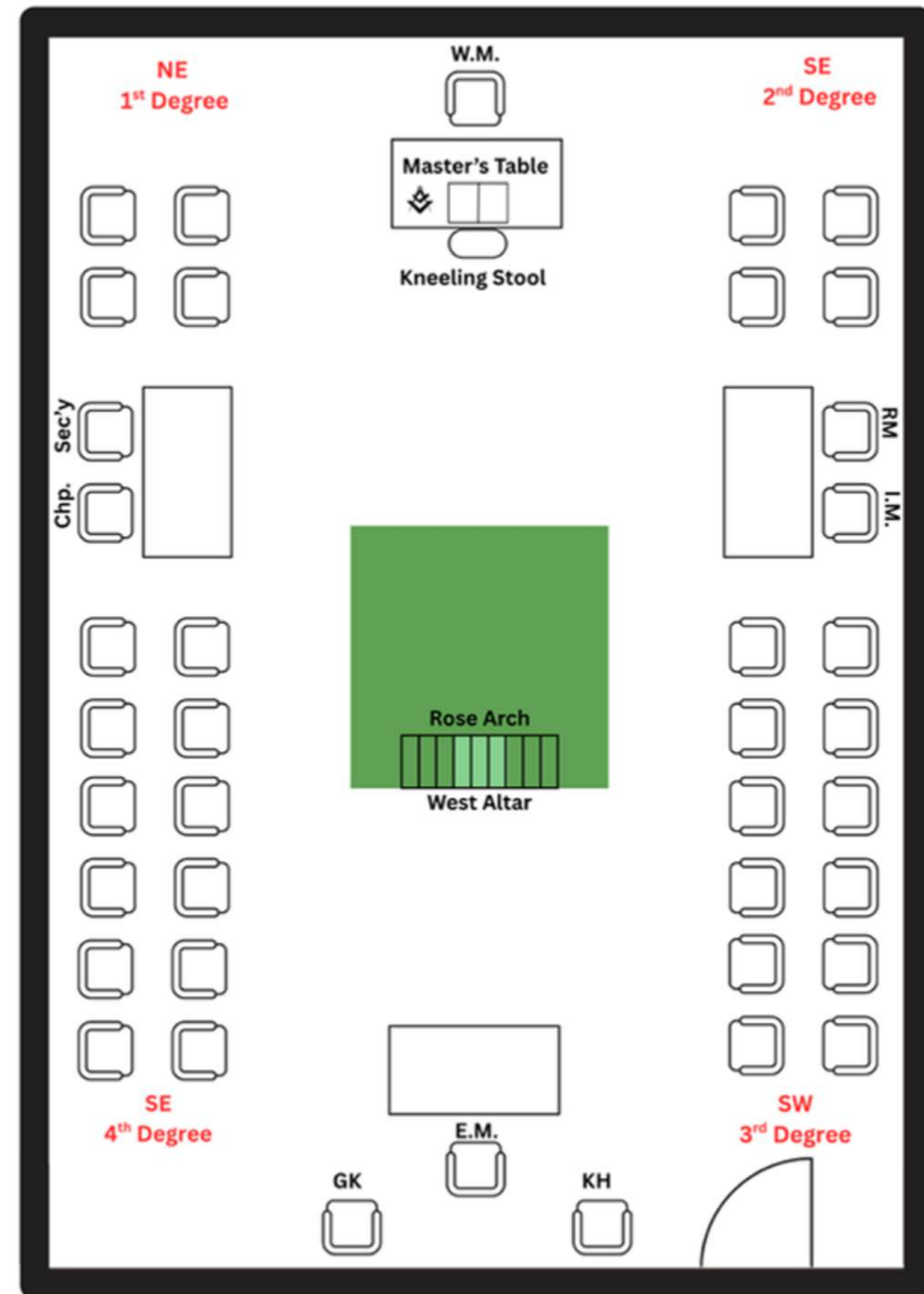
The Lodge Room

- Cherubim at the entrance of Eden (EM, KH, GK)
- EM - examines and instructs seekers to determine their worthiness to enter the garden.
- Keyholder guards the inner gate/Gatekeeper guards the outer gate.



The Lodge Room

- Gatekeeper alone can cross the the threshold between outer and inner worlds (outside world & the lodge)
- Instruction Master alone moves between the Paradise Garden (square) and Lodge (rectangle)
- Gatekeeper = *Outer Psychopomp*
- Instruction Master = *Inner Psychopomp*
- *Psychopomp* - ψυχοπομπός (psychopompós), literally meaning the 'guide of souls' in Greek.



Role of the Keepers

- Role of the Keepers (officers) inspired by Adam (“And the Lord God took the man and put him in the Garden of Eden to tend and keep it.”)
- Instruction Master stands between the Seeker and the Archetype of the 1st Degree (snake)
- *“To support, encourage and protect our brothers and sisters whenever possible. To strive earnestly, sincerely, and zealously, for the Friendship of every member.”*



The Apprentice Apron

- Apprentice must put on their own apron (unassisted) - avoid temptation to grasp knowledge all at once (Adam and Eve)
- Temptation and Wiles of the Evil One



The Instruction Master

- The Safeguard against false or premature knowledge
- The first degree = love
- The second degree = wisdom.
- The third degree = harmony.
- The fourth degree = truth.
- The Altar in the West block the entrance (rose arch) into Eden (Working Carpet)
- Hubris - *excessive pride or arrogance*



5th Day of Creation

“So God created the great creatures of the sea and every living thing with which the water teems and that moves about in it... And God saw that it was good... And there was evening, and there was morning—the fifth day.” (Genesis 1:21, 23)

P G
H E

- Four Degree system rooted in Kabbalah
- Adam Kadmon (ah-dahm kahd-mohn)
- As Above, So Below
- 1 Genesis - Adam Kadmon formed from divine light (heavens)
- 2 Genesis - Adam formed from clay (earth)



